



Vendor · Canonical Shape Directory

Reference · v2.0 · 5-segment

The 5-segment vendor identity — locked grammar. $\text{PAY_SEQ} \times \text{SELLS} \times \text{OPM} \times \text{PMS} \times \text{IDENTITY}$. Brand scope is still computed from the RM ring at query time.

SECTION 1

The 5-segment vendor identity

The vendor canonical code carries five locked dimensions: **PAY_SEQ** (cash-flow direction), **SELLS** (what they stock — RM scope), **OPM** (how we order — manual vs automatable), **PMS** (which payment methods they accept), and **IDENTITY** (unique abbreviation). Brand scope is still a **computed view** derived from the RM ring at query time.

This obeys the COA Doctrine: every dimension is fully enumerated, the constraint set rejects impossible combinations, and the canonical code IS the operation — not a description of it. New vendors slot into the same space without schema migration.

TOTAL VENDORS

—

live in editor

PAY-FIRST (PF)

—

cash leaves first

RECEIVE-FIRST (RF)

—

goods arrive first

LINKED VS ORPHAN

—

RM-referenced vendors

[↗ Vendor Editor](#)

[↗ RM Editor](#)

[↗ RM Shape Directory](#)

[↗ COA Doctrine](#)

[↓ Live Census](#)

SECTION 2

Code Anatomy — 5 segments, left to right

**{PAY_SEQ} - {SELLS} - {OPM} - {PMS} -
{IDENTITY}**

SELLS

POSITION 2 · 1-2 CHARS · WHAT THEY STOCK (RM SCOPE)

L = Loose only · **B** = Branded only · **LB** = Both (alphabetical). RM-purchase scope only.

3 values · L · B · LB

PMS

POSITION 4 · 1-2 CHARS · PAYMENT-METHOD SUPPORT

C = Cash-only · **B** = Bank-only · **Cb** / **Bc** = Hybrid (uppercase = primary rail, lowercase = alternate). Mirrors SOURCING Lb/Bl.

4 values · C · B · Cb · Bc

IDENTITY

POSITION 5 · 3-10 CHARS UPPERCASE

Unique abbreviation drawn from the vendor name. Auto-derived (consonants vowel-stripped); owner-overridable. Globally unique across all vendors regardless of the four leading dimensions.

PRABHU · ZEPTO · SHARIFF · HYPERPURE · WALKIN

Reading order: PAY_SEQ (cash direction) → SELLS (what they stock) → OPM (how we order) → PMS (how we pay) → IDENTITY (who they are). Five locked dimensions, all enumerated; brand scope still computed from the RM ring upstream.

SECTION 3

PAY_SEQ directory Position 1 · 2 chars

The architectural binary that classifies every vendor by cash-flow direction.

CODE	MEANING	REAL EXAMPLES
Pf	Pay-first. Money leaves our account before goods/service arrives. Quick commerce apps, prepaid subscriptions, advance rent, prepaid utilities.	Pf-B-A-B-ZEPT0 · Pf-L-M-C-WALKIN
Rf	Receive-first. Goods/service arrives before money goes out. Daily milk, departmental stores with credit terms, post-paid utilities, monthly bills.	Rf-L-M-C-PRABHU · Rf-LB-M-Cb- SHARIFF

Why a binary, not a 6-letter V-shape?

The richer V-shapes (V1a / V1b / V2 / V3 / V4 / V5) capture the precise cash-flow choreography of a single purchase event. Those live at the *action layer* and modulate per-purchase, per-supplier within a single vendor record. PAY_SEQ at the vendor level only captures the dominant direction — that's enough for the entity ring; the action ring fills in the granularity.

SECTION 3.5

SELLS directory Position 2 · 1-2 chars

What the vendor stocks at the RM-purchase layer. Subset of {L, B}, alphabetically ordered, non-empty.

CODE	MEANING	REAL EXAMPLES
L	Loose only. Vendor only deals in unbranded RM by weight/volume — daily milk, vegetables, mutton, fish, walk-in emergency procurement.	Rf-L-M-C-PRABHU (loose milk)
B	Branded only. Vendor only stocks SKU-coded branded goods — quick commerce apps, B2B platforms, dedicated brand suppliers.	Pf-B-A-B-ZEPTO · Rf-B-A-Bc- HYPERPURE
LB	Both Loose and Branded. Mixed departmental stores or wholesalers that stock unbranded staples plus branded SKUs side by side. Always alphabetical — never BL.	Rf-LB-M-Cb- SHARIFF (departmental store)

Future SELLS extension

When the bill/expense scope opens (rent, utilities, services, capex), the SELLS alphabet extends to include S (services) and C (capex). New combinations like LBS, BC, S become valid points in the same space — **no migration required**. The constraint set widens; the existing {L, B, LB} rows stay valid.

SECTION 3.6

OPM directory Position 3 · 1 char

Order-Placement Method — how an order with this vendor is initiated. Binary: human-mediated vs automatable.

CODE	MEANING	REAL EXAMPLES
M	Manual. Ordering routes through a human channel — phone call, WhatsApp, walk-in, or a fixed daily/weekly delivery route. No app/API in the loop.	Rf-L-M-C-PRABHU (daily route) · Rf-LB-M-Cb-SHARIFF (WA)
A	Automatable. Ordering can be placed by a Cron Worker via app, web portal, or API — quick commerce, B2B platforms, marketplace integrations.	Pf-B-A-B-ZEPT0 (app) · Rf-B-A-Bc-HYPERPURE (B2B)

Why this dimension

OPM separates "needs a human to send WA" from "Cron Worker can place the order." That binary is the gate that decides whether an action becomes agent-emitted (A) or staff-emitted (M). Without OPM in the canonical code, automation routing requires lookup; with it, the agent reads the coordinate and acts.

SECTION 3.7

PMS directory Position 4 · 1-2 chars

Payment-Method Support — which payment rails this vendor accepts. Two letters, case-encoded for hybrid primaries. Mirrors SOURCING Lb/Bl and USAGE Pr/Rp.

Letter set · pure rails

CODE	MEANING	REAL EXAMPLES
C	Cash-only. Vendor doesn't accept bank rails — no UPI, no NEFT, no card. Settlement always physical.	Rf-L-M-C-PRABHU (small loose milk vendor)
B	Bank-only. Vendor doesn't accept cash — typical for app-based platforms, registered B2B suppliers, online subscriptions, GST-registered wholesalers. UPI / NEFT / card / cheque only.	Pf-B-A-B-ZEPTO

Case-encoded combinations · hybrid rails

When a vendor accepts both rails, the canonical code uses two letters: **uppercase** = primary (default) rail, **lowercase** = alternate. The information thrown away by a flat H letter — which rail is the default — is preserved here.

CODE	MEANING	REAL EXAMPLES
Cb	Hybrid · Cash primary. Vendor accepts both, but cash is the default rail; bank is the alternate. Common for small/local vendors who occasionally take UPI.	Rf-LB-M-Cb-SHARIFF (departmental store)
Bc	Hybrid · Bank primary. Vendor accepts both, but bank is the default rail; cash is the alternate. B2B platforms / registered vendors with COD option.	Rf-B-A-Bc-HYPERPURE (B2B with cash possible)

Forbidden combinations · what the regex rejects

FORBIDDEN	WHY CAUGHT
PMS empty	Every vendor accepts at least one rail. Empty PMS would mean "we cannot pay this vendor at all" — not a valid operational state.
bC · cB	Lowercase-first reverses the primary/alternate convention. Primary letter must be uppercase.
Cc · Bb	Each letter (C, B) appears at most once. Duplicate is meaningless.
CB · BC	Both uppercase declares two primaries — only one rail can be primary at a time.

FORBIDDEN

WHY CAUGHT

Letter outside {C, B}

The two-rail enumeration is exhaustive at the entity layer. New rails (e.g. crypto) would require a doctrine extension, not a free-form letter.

What PMS does NOT capture

PMS describes what the vendor *accepts* and *which rail is primary*, not what was used. The exact payment channel for a specific bill (UPI vs cash for a Cb vendor, NEFT vs UPI for a B vendor) is a property of the action — settled when the transaction happens. PMS only narrows the option space; the action picks one.

SECTION 4

IDENTITY directory Position 5 · 3-10 chars

A 3-10 character uppercase abbreviation that gives the vendor its identity within the global vendor namespace.

Length

3 to 10 characters, uppercase A-Z and 0-9 only. Codes need to stay scannable.

Source

Auto-derived from vendor name (consonants, vowels stripped, deduplicated). Owner override allowed.

Uniqueness

Globally unique across ALL vendors regardless of the four leading dimensions. Rf-
L-M-C-PRABHU blocks Pf-B-A-B-PRABHU .

Case

Always uppercase. Editor and API normalise lowercase on save.

Sample derivations

VENDOR NAME	AUTO-DERIVED IDENTITY	NOTES
Prabhu Buffalo Milk Vendor	PRABHU	Lead noun retained
Zepto	ZEPTO	Brand name as-is
Shariff Departmental Store	SHARIFF	Lead noun
Rent — Hamza HKP	RENT	Functional handle
BESCOM (Electricity)	ELECTRICITY	Function over brand
BSNL Internet	INTERNET	Function over brand

When two vendors play the same operational role (e.g. two electricity providers across outlets), use a discriminator suffix in IDENTITY — Pf-B-A-B-ELECTRICNCH, Pf-B-A-B-ELECTRICHE.

SECTION 5

Forbidden Combinations

Every anomaly the system rejects, in one place. The math literally cannot represent these.

FORBIDDEN	WHY CAUGHT	RESULT
<code>PAY_SEQ</code> outside {Pf, Rf}	The architectural binary is exhaustive — any third value would require a doctrine change.	
<code>SELLS</code> empty	RM-purchase scope requires at least one of {L, B}.	
<code>SELLS</code> outside {L, B, LB}	Constraint set in RM-purchase scope. S/C reserved for the bill/expense scope.	
<code>SELLS</code> = "BL"	Subsets must be alphabetically ordered — only "LB" is canonical.	
<code>OPM</code> outside {M, A}	Manual / Automatable is the exhaustive binary — no third state.	
<code>PMS</code> outside {C, B, Cb, Bc}	Cash-only / Bank-only / case-encoded Hybrids is the exhaustive enumeration. Lowercase-first (cB), duplicates (Cc), or both uppercase (CB) all rejected.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> empty	Identity required.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> < 3 chars	Codes need to stay readable.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> > 10 chars	Codes need to stay scannable.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> collision	Two vendors cannot share the same identity, even when the four leading dimensions differ.	
Lowercase / non-alphanumeric	<code>IDENTITY</code> is uppercase A-Z and 0-9 only.	

FORBIDDEN	WHY CAUGHT	RESULT
DELETE while RM-referenced	Cannot orphan an RM's supplier link silently — caller must remove from RM tree first.	

SECTION 6

Live Vendor Census — All Vendors Today

Fetches live from `/api/vendors`. Each vendor shows its declared SELLS / OPM / PMS pills plus the brand scope computed from the RM ring. Click any code to open the editor.

Could not load live census from `/api/vendors` — Failed to fetch. The endpoint may need a valid PIN; this directory shares the editor's auth.

SECTION 7

Worked Examples — Reading codes left to right

Six real codes (one hypothetical), each decomposed segment by segment.

1 · Rf-L-M-C-PRABHU — Daily loose milk vendor

Rf-L-M-C-PRABHU | | | | L PRABHU – identity (loose buffalo milk vendor in Shivajinagar) | | | C – Cash-only (small vendor, no bank rail at all) | | M – Manual order (we WhatsApp him daily) | L – Loose only (unbranded buffalo milk by litre) Rf – Receive-first (delivers milk daily; settled weekly/monthly)

Reads as: "Receive-first, sells loose, manually ordered, cash-only vendor named PRABHU." Computed scope from RM ring = NCH (only NCH consumes buffalo milk).

2 · Pf-B-A-B-ZEPTO — Quick commerce platform

Pf-B-A-B-ZEPTO | | | | L ZEPTO – identity (the quick commerce platform) | | B – Bank-only (no cash settlement; in-app UPI/card payment) | | A – Automatable (Cron Worker can place orders via app/API) | B – Branded only (SKU-coded packs – Zepto doesn't deal in loose) Pf – Pay-first (paid in-app, then 10-minute delivery)

Reads as: "Pay-first, branded only, automatable, bank-only vendor named ZEPTO." Note PMS position 4 carries a single uppercase B — distinct from SELLS at position 2, even though they share the letter shape. Computed scope = HN (cross-brand — both NCH and HE order from Zepto).

3 · Rf-LB-M-Cb-SHARIFF — Mixed departmental store, cash primary

Rf-LB-M-Cb-SHARIFF | | | | L SHARIFF – identity (Shivajinagar departmental store) | | Cb – Hybrid · Cash primary + Bank alt (accepts UPI but cash is default) | M – Manual order (we WhatsApp / call / walk-in) | LB – Both Loose and Branded (alphabetical) Rf – Receive-first (collect goods, settle monthly)

Reads as: "Receive-first, sells both loose and branded, manually ordered, cash-primary hybrid vendor named SHARIFF." Per-transaction settlement (which UPI handle, exact split for a partial-bank payment) decided at action layer; Cb just declares the entity-level option space.

4 · Rf-B-A-Bc-HYPERPURE — B2B platform with COD option

Rf-B-A-Bc-HYPERPURE | | | | L HYPERPURE – identity (Zomato's B2B sourcing platform) | | Bc – Hybrid · Bank primary + Cash alt (NEFT/UPI

default; cash possible on COD orders) | | _____ A - Automatable (B2B portal supports API) | _____ B - Branded only (SKU-coded wholesale)
_____ Rf - Receive-first (delivery + invoice; settle on credit terms)

Reads as: "Receive-first, branded only, automatable, bank-primary hybrid vendor named HYPERPURE." Distinct from ZEPTO on two dimensions: PAY_SEQ (Hyperpure invoices on credit, Zepto charges in-app upfront) and PMS (Bc vs B — Hyperpure has a fall-back cash option on COD).

5 · Pf-L-M-C-WALKIN — Emergency walk-in procurement

Pf-L-M-C-WALKIN | | | | _____ WALKIN - identity (functional handle for ad-hoc local buys) | | | _____ C - Cash-only (counter purchase, immediate cash; no bank rail) | | _____ M - Manual order (staff walks to local shop) |
_____ L - Loose only (vegetables / mutton emergency top-up)
_____ Pf - Pay-first (cash handed over before goods loaded)

Reads as: "Pay-first, loose only, manually ordered, cash-only vendor named WALKIN." A functional vendor record covering all ad-hoc emergency procurement — counts as one entity even though physical shops vary.

6 · Rf-LB-A-Cb-FUTUREVEND — Hypothetical future state

Rf-LB-A-Cb-FUTUREVEND | | | | _____ FUTUREVEND - identity (a hypothetical mixed-stock vendor with API) | | | _____ Cb - Hybrid · Cash primary + Bank alt (vendor adopts UPI alongside legacy cash, but cash still default) | |
_____ A - Automatable (vendor exposes WhatsApp Business API or webform)
| _____ LB - Loose + Branded (mixed stock continues) _____
Rf - Receive-first (continues as credit terms vendor)

Reads as: "Receive-first, mixed stock, automatable, cash-primary hybrid vendor."
Demonstrates that **SHARIFF could legitimately migrate** to Rf-LB-A-Cb-SHARIFF the day they expose ordering automation — a single PUT updates the row, the canonical code re-keys, and the action ring picks up the change with no further migration. If they later flip to bank-primary (modal payment becomes UPI), another PUT moves the row to Bc.

SECTION 8

What stays out of the code

An obvious instinct would be to encode BRAND scope (NCH/HE/HN) directly in the vendor code: `Rf-L-M-C-NCH-PRABHU`. We deliberately don't — and the same discipline applies to several other tempting fields:

BRAND scope is derivable. It changes when the RM ring changes — without any vendor mutation. Encoding it statically would create sync drift the day NCH stops using PRABHU.

Per-transaction payment method. Whether a hybrid vendor was paid in UPI or cash for a specific bill is a property of the action, not the vendor. PMS narrows the option space; the action picks one.

Money source / L3 routing. Which bank account, which till, which UPI handle paid this vendor — that's a Layer-3 ledger concern, not a vendor identity concern.

Communication channel. Phone/WhatsApp/email is a property field. OPM captures whether ordering can be automated; the actual contact details are `data_json`.

Bank account / contact details. Pure properties — they live in `data_json`, never in the canonical code.

Five canonical dimensions; everything else is property or derived view.

In the static row

- `vendor_code` (Pf/Rf-SELLS-OPM-PMS-IDENTITY)
- `pay_seq`, `sells`, `opm`, `pms`, `identity_abbr`, `vendor_name`
- `communication / location / payment / GST` in `data_json`

Never in the static row

- BRAND scope (derivable from RM ring)
- Per-transaction payment method (action layer)
- Money source / L3 routing (ledger)
- Communication channel (property)
- Bank account / contact (property)
- V-shape (action layer)

Future SELLS dimension extension

The current SELLS alphabet is $\{L, B\}$ with subsets $\{L, B, LB\}$, valid in RM-purchase scope only. When the bill/expense scope opens (rent, utilities, services, capex), the alphabet extends: S = services, C = capex. Combinations like LBS , BC , S become valid — same constraint pattern (alphabetical, non-empty subset), just a

wider letter set. **No migration required:** existing rows stay valid, the CHECK constraint widens, and new combinations slot in as new points in the same space.

SECTION 9

Connection to the RM ring + Action layer

The vendor ring is the **second entity ring**, sitting alongside the RM ring. Both feed downstream into the Action ring (purchases, productions, transfers).

Composition of an Action code (sketch)

`{ACTION}-{RM_CODE}-{VENDOR_CODE}-{V_SHAPE}-{TXN_ID}`

Examples:

PUR-NCH-AM-P-Lb-MLK-Rf-L-M-C-PRABHU-V1a-2026050801	← daily milk
PUR-HN-AM-P-BL-BTR-Pf-B-A-B-ZEPT0-V3-2026050802	← Amul butter
PUR-HN-AM-P-Lb-VEG-Rf-LB-M-Cb-SHARIFF-V2-2026050803	← veg + bra

RM ring

Five segments — what was bought. Vendor refs live inside data_json at the L / B / I layers.

Vendor ring (this page)

Five segments — cash direction · what they sell · how we order · how they accept payment · who they are. Brand scope still computed via the RM ring.

Action ring

Composes RM + Vendor + V-shape into a transactional code that an Event can aggregate. Defined in COA Doctrine.

Two entity rings, one action ring, one event ring. Every action code is a coordinate; every event aggregates actions. The vendor ring stays minimal so the action ring stays composable.

[Doctrine](#)

[Vendor Editor](#) [RM Shape Directory](#) [COA](#)